

University of Michigan

Fall 2025 Instructor Report

EECS 110-001: Discover CS

Madelyn Gatchel

23 out of 31 students responded to this evaluation.

Responses to University-wide questions about the course:

	SA	A	N	D	SD	N/A	Your Median	School/College Median	Univ-Wide Median
This course advanced my understanding of the subject matter. (Q1631)	12	11	0	0	0	0	4.5	4.5	4.5
My interest in the subject has increased because of this course. (Q1632)	9	9	4	1	0	0	4.2	4.2	4.2
I knew what was expected of me in this course.(Q1633)	14	9	0	0	0	0	4.7	4.5	4.5
I had a strong desire to take this course.(Q4)	5	11	6	1	0	0	3.9	4.1	4.0
As compared with other courses of equal credit, the workload for this course was (SA=Much Lighter, A=Lighter, N=Typical, D=Heavier, SD=Much Heavier). (Q891)	2	4	14	3	0	0	3.1	2.9	3.0

Responses to University-wide questions about the instructor:

	SA	A	N	D	SD	N/A	Your Median	School/College Median	Univ-Wide Median
Madelyn Gatchel seemed well prepared for class meetings.(Q230)	23	0	0	0	0	0	5.0	4.7	4.8
Madelyn Gatchel explained material clearly.(Q199)	17	5	1	0	0	0	4.8	4.7	4.7
Madelyn Gatchel treated students with respect.(Q217)	22	1	0	0	0	0	5.0	4.8	4.8

Responses to questions about the course:

	SA	A	N	D	SD	N/A	Your Median
Overall, this was an excellent course. (Q1)	13	10	0	0	0	0	4.6
I felt included and valued when working with other students. (Q253)	16	5	2	0	0	0	4.8

Responses to questions about the instructor:

	SA	A	N	D	SD	N/A	Your Median
Overall, Madelyn Gatchel was an excellent teacher. (Q2)	16	7	0	0	0	0	4.8

This course maintained a good balance between Python instruction and non-coding components (e.g., guest speakers, interview assignment, industry tour).

(custom question added by the instructor)

SA	A	N	D	SD	N/A	Your Median
17	6	0	0	0	0	4.8

In this class, I learned about various ways to explore computer science at Michigan (e.g., interdisciplinary research, extracurriculars, minors, and majors).

(custom question added by the instructor)

SA	A	N	D	SD	N/A	Your Median
14	9	0	0	0	0	4.7

This class provided opportunities to learn about different computing-related career paths (e.g., software engineer, researcher, faculty member).

(custom question added by the instructor)

SA	A	N	SD	D	N/A	Your Median
16	6	1	0	0	0	4.8

The medians are calculated from Fall 2025 data. University-wide medians are based on all UM classes in which an item was used. The school/college medians in this report are based on classes that are lower division with enrollment of 16 to 74 in College of Engineering.

Written Comments

Comment on the quality of instruction in this course. (Q900)

Comments
I understood what i needed to do
Madelyn and Angelina are great teachers that gave clear and helpful instructions on this course that made me feel comfortable in the classroom environment and assignments.
I think the way that this course is taught is good. Sometimes the teaching is super basic compared to the homework, but it is good because it makes you think hard about what you learned and apply.
The presentations that the teacher has prepared explain the contents clearly, and include everything we would need to know to succeed for this class.
Madelyn did a very good job. While sometimes it seemed like she was moving too fast, she was always willing to discuss and help students during labs or in office hours.
The quality of the course is amazing. From the field trips, to the instruction. Everything about this class is amazing and is very helpful with learning python. Especially as someone who's majoring in Political Science, all my questions get answered, and I've left this class knowing much more about python than I had originally known.
Very good
I very much enjoyed this course. It showed me that I am definitely much more interested in coding, and I want to explore other computer science classes here at Michigan. I really enjoyed learning from Madelyn, and going to office hours helped me to feel so much more confident in what I was doing.
The course was everything that it should be for an introductory Python course. Madelyn always seemed excited and ready to teach the course material and is very easily approachable.
There were plenty of resources available. The lectures were also clear.
very good
I would say the instruction of the course was very well. Madelyn did a great job at explaining everything that was asked of us students and really emphasized getting help when needed. She was very welcoming and understanding when I needed help understanding a topic better. Our AI Angelina Lee was also very helpful.
The instruction quality was excellent. Madelyn is an excellent instructor who makes sure students know what material is taught in this course.
I felt like I learned new things from a genuine instructor every class.
Madelyn is an amazing instructor that is able to break down complex topics in a very easily digestible manner. She is obviously very smart and passionate about what she does and that alone helped my understanding of the course and how much I desired to contribute to it.
The course seemed to be very thoughtfully put together; however, I found it hard to actually retain what I was taught and understand concepts completely. I feel the Lecture section of the class moved quite fast and made it harder to learn the material.
Very detailed, interactive/collaborative, and overall a class I enjoyed being in.
Madelyn is always open to students coming to her office hours with questions, replied quickly to emails, and I was always able to easily ask her all my questions.

What were the strengths of the course ? (Q953)

Comments
The teacher was really nice and office hours was really helpful to me
There is great help from the instructors with the teaching portion during class and extra guidance during office hours. Also the different functions are explained well in the weekly presentations.
Only one day a week is good. Also homework is fun.
The homework is very project-based, which I enjoy.
The strengths of this course were the group labs and homeworks.
Everything about it. I love that it's only one day a week. It contributed to my schedule only consisting of three days of classes.
Very good class structure and fair deadlines
This course was super strong in helping me understand what each line of code was actually doing. It also gave me ample opportunities to practice what I was learning as we went. I think figuring out code through the labs and homework assignments significantly helped me when it was time to do the final project.
I really liked that we explored other CS paths at Michigan, both for people looking into and not looking into majoring/minoring in the field.
The course is accessible for students who have little to no experience with coding.
beginner friendly
It was a great introductory course. It gives a glimpse into the world of Computer Science and as someone who didn't really consider pursuing Computer Science before entering college, this course allowed me to learn more about and made me much more interested in possibly pursuing the CS major.
I like the balance between lecture and lab as it provides an opportunity right after learning material to go and apply it.
Constant and effective learning.
It was definitely a strong introduction to a very user-friendly programming language. I believe that the majority of students should easily be able to handle most mid-level projects using the information learned from this course.
The course had a lot of variety to it, the guest speakers and visit to Atomic Object made the course 1000% more entertaining and engaging.
The collaboration and discussion on the various python topics.
The group homeworks and labs allowed students to think together, which made it less stressful of a learning experience. The homework load was very reasonable and I never struggled with deadlines

What suggestions would you make for improving the course ? (Q955)

Comments
none
One suggestion I do have is maybe changing the course description because a good portion of class work and topics relate more towards students who have some experience not the full on coding beginners.
Less speakers and more homework/coding things and projects. Those were fun
I think this course is trying to cover a lot of coding material in not enough time. I feel like there should be more time to understand each topic.
I would suggest slowing down the lectures so that people can get a better grasp on the material initially.
More kahoots! I loved the one we did at the end, and would've loved doing more. If you can find the time/space to fit them into the lessons. Also, I think I would've benefited more from longer classes, like at least 30 minutes more would've been a game changer for me.
More time on lectures
Sometimes the lectures go by too fast, making it hard to keep up.
more kahoot
I don't think there is much I would change, maybe include small refreshers from previous classes because there were times I would often forget how to do a specific task due to the class only being held once a week.
N/A
Would love to have a few more recommended resources to keep moving forward on my own
I don't really have any suggestions, I think it was a great course that accomplished exactly what it set out to do. It was personally too slow for me but that's more a problem with what course I took rather than the course itself. I know some people struggled more than I did and I expect that the pacing of this course accommodates them better than I.
Find a better way to teach lecture material, maybe something more interactive, and have a short but beneficial assignment that is placed later in the week, so students can revisit ideas taught in class throughout the week.
Increase the time for the presentation.
Less lecture based/more interactive materials.

How might the class climate be made more inclusive of diverse students? (Q910)

Comments
n/a
For more diversity in interacting with each other, there could be a switch of groups so students can meet other coders and their styles in the class up until the final group project?
I don't think this is anything to worry about
The class should have more projects that look at the history of python or notable figures from all around the world.
I think the class was already extremely inclusive as is.
No idea. It felt very inclusive to me.
Simple language ESL.
im not sure
Overall, I think they did a great job being inclusive of diverse students. I never really felt out of place or intimidated by those around me.
N/A
I don't see how this would be possible or how the question is even relevant to the course. I truly believe that if any student had an issue within the course because of something they could not control that they could reach out to her and she would respond in an accommodating fashion.
I feel it is good.
N/A